

VOCABULARY MASTERBOOK

Targeted guidance, worked examples and original practice. Use after an attempt, then transfer the correction to a new context.

Know what the official tasks ask

Grammar & Vocabulary contains 25 vocabulary questions as well as 25 grammar questions. The vocabulary constructs are definitions, similar meaning, use in sentence context and word combinations. The mock vocabulary sets in this revision have five prompts and ten options per set. Follow each set's instructions and read all options.

A synonym task asks for the closest meaning, not a word that can replace the target in every possible sentence. A usage item requires a choice that fits both grammar and meaning. A combination task depends on conventional usage: knowing the separate words may not be enough.

For each question, identify what is being tested before choosing. If the gap follows a preposition, an -ing form or noun may be needed. If several options are grammatical, compare their meanings and the exact context. Do not treat every familiar expression as the answer.

Learn a unit large enough to use

Record "take responsibility for a mistake", not only "responsibility". Record "a sharp increase in prices", not only "sharp". Include the usual object or preposition and a short sentence that matters to you.

Useful families of combinations: make a recommendation / raise a concern / reach an agreement / meet a requirement / draw a conclusion / address a problem / provide evidence / fulfil a commitment. They are related in purpose but do not share one universal verb.

Common repairs: "do progress" -> "make progress"; "strong rain" -> "heavy rain"; "depend of" -> "depend on"; "an evidence" -> "a piece of evidence" or "some evidence". Store the corrected chunk and the reason, rather than an isolated list of wrong forms.

Synonym nuance prevents expensive mistakes

Available means accessible or free to be used; suitable means appropriate for a purpose. A room can be available but unsuitable. Effective describes achieving a result; efficient adds the idea of avoiding unnecessary time or resources. A method can be effective but inefficient.

A refund returns money already paid. A discount reduces the price. A deposit is part-payment or security, depending on the arrangement. These words concern money but cannot be selected simply because a sentence mentions payment.

Plausible means reasonably believable, not proven. Tentative means not final. Inconclusive evidence fails to settle the issue. These distinctions become important in Weeks 6-8, when a speaker or writer may accept part of a claim while limiting its certainty.

Prepositions and verb patterns

Learn the whole pattern: responsible for; interested in; compatible with; dependent on; an effect on; a reason for; an advantage over; access to. A translation from another language may suggest a preposition that English does not use.

Some verbs take a direct object: discuss the issue, explain the rule, affect attendance, request information. Others need a preposition: respond to a request, apply for a place, refer to a notice, object to a proposal.

After a prepositional to, use a noun or -ing form: look forward to hearing; be accustomed to working; object to paying. Do not confuse this to with the infinitive marker in "hope to hear".

Confusing words and useful word families

Affect is usually a verb meaning influence; effect is usually a noun meaning result. Advice is a noun; advise is a verb. Rise does not take a direct object, whereas raise does: prices rise, a company raises prices.

Check the grammatical role before choosing a family member: accurate / accuracy / accurately; clear / clarity / clarify; significant / significance / significantly; reliable / reliability / reliably. Learning the family is useful when it helps you select a form in context, not as an exercise in collecting every possible derivative.

Avoid a false upgrade. "Use" does not automatically become better as "utilise". "Help" may be more natural than "facilitate" in a message to a friend. Lexical range means having appropriate choices and controlling their use.

A retrieval cycle that tests transfer

Day 0: attempt an item before consulting the key. Record the complete correction and one sentence about your own life.

Day 2: cover the phrase and retrieve it from its meaning or a new sentence. Day 7: use it in a short timed response. Day 14: mix it with similar expressions and explain the difference.

If you remember the letter but cannot explain the choice, the exercise has become a memory test of the page. Change the context. For "raise a concern", write a new sentence about a different service, then contrast it with "rise" in another sentence.

Mark a tracker entry fixed only after two successful uses on separate days. Repeated errors deserve a small targeted set, not a longer undifferentiated vocabulary list.

Decision speed without careless guessing

In later weeks, take a first decision promptly, flag genuine uncertainty and move on. Return with a reason: a meaning distinction, grammar requirement or collocation. Changing an answer merely because another option looks more sophisticated is not a strategy.

For a five-item matching set, solve clear matches first and then reconsider the remaining options. Do not force a remaining word into a gap if its meaning does not fit. Read the completed sentence once more before finalising the set.

After a mock, separate unknown vocabulary from misreading, poor time allocation and confusing two known words. The repair differs: learn a new chunk, slow down at a key qualifier, practise a timed decision, or compare meanings in fresh contexts.

Mini-drills | answers in the Complete Answer Book

MBV-E01 | MEANING IN CONTEXT

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBV-E01-Q01

The room is free on Tuesday but too small for the group. Explain available versus suitable.

MBV-E01-Q02

A shop returns the money you already paid. Is this a deposit, discount or refund?

MBV-E01-Q03

An explanation fits the known facts but has not been proved. Is it plausible or certain?

MBV-E02 | REPAIR THE CHUNK

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBV-E02-Q01

Correct: "The team did steady progress."

MBV-E02-Q02

Correct: "We discussed about the revised timetable."

MBV-E02-Q03

Correct: "The result depends of the sample."

MBV-E02-Q04

Correct: "Could you give me an advice?"

MBV-E02-Q05

Correct: "The centre rose its prices."

MBV-E03 | CHOOSE THE RIGHT FAMILY MEMBER

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBV-E03-Q01

Complete with a form of accurate: "We need to check the ____ of the figures."

MBV-E03-Q02

Complete with a form of clear: "Could you ____ the final requirement?"

MBV-E03-Q03

Complete with a form of significant: "Attendance increased ____."

MBV-E03-Q04

Complete with a form of rely: "The information must be ____."

MBV-E04 | TRANSFER, NOT REPETITION

Attempt each repair before consulting the Answer Book. Suggested answers are not the only valid wording.

MBV-E04-Q01

Write a new sentence about a service using "raise a concern", then one about prices using "rise".

MBV-E04-Q02

Explain a situation in which a method is effective but inefficient.
